

Orunodoi 2.0 was launched on December 14, 2022

projects of social and financial inclusion, aspiring to bring equality in the social infrastructure. One such endeavour has been Assam government's Orunodoi (The rising of Sun) scheme which has emerged as a paradigm of socio-economic empowerment of women and the underprivileged. "Orunodoi has literally given the women of our state a ray of hope, symbolized by the rising sun. This is an unprecedented development milestone achieved by our government, which has had multiple benefits—economic empowerment, financial literacy, extension of nutritional support and, above all, taking development to each and every home and heart," says Assam Chief Minister Dr Himanta Biswa Sarma.

Orunodoi was first introduced as the 'foremost pearl' among the Ashtadash Mukutar Unnoyonee Maala (A string of 18 development pearls), a flagship programme with 18 development objectives, announced in the state budget of 2020-21, which was presented in the Assembly by Dr Sarma, who was then the finance minister. The rationale behind the launch of this scheme was this: if the government can guarantee a minimum amount to the poorest of the poor for their health and nutritional needs directly to the family, then a lot of the fragmented beneficiary-oriented schemes can be restructured and subsumed, and largescale gains can be passed on to the families.

Accordingly, Orunodoi was envisaged with a provision of a cash transfer on a monthly basis so that underprivileged families are assured of minimum monthly cash flow through sustained financial assistance. The Orunodoi scheme was first launched in August 2020 and was rolled out for adult females, who were permanent residents of Assam, were residing in Assam and whose composite household income was less than Rs 2,00,000 per annum.

Initially, an amount of Rs 830 was provided to the beneficiaries every month, directly credited to their bank account. The breakup was monthly support of Rs 400 per family per month to be given to each family for procuring medicines for taking care of their health needs. A sum of Rs 200 per family per month which provides a 50 per cent subsidy for the 4 kgs of pulses a family consumes in a month. Another sum of Rs 80 per month per family which subsidizes 50 per cent of the monthly expenditure they spend on the 4 kgs of sugar that they purchase for the household every month. To purchase essential fruits and vegetables over and beyond what they

FINANCIAL OUTLAY OF ORUNODOI SCHEME

Financial Year	Total beneficiary (In Lakh)	Yearly Financial Outlay (In Crores)
2020-2021	19.3	825
2021-2022	19.3	2000
2022-2023	19.3 (17.07 from October, 2023)	2700
2023-2024	27.5 (17.07 upto March, 2023)	4200



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Dr Himanta Biswa Sarma
Chief Minister, Assam

Students conducting house-to-house survey of beneficiaries

